# Hooper Markert

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## Education

**Washington University in St. Louis**, St. Louis, MO — Expected May 2027
M.A. in Economics

**Columbia University**, New York, NY — May 2025
B.A. in Neuroscience and Behavior
*Magna cum laude; Phi Beta Kappa*

## Selected Graduate Coursework

PhD Quantitative Methods I (8710); Graduate Econometrics; Graduate Macroeconomics; Graduate Microeconomics; Macroeconomics of Inequality

## Research Interests

Development economics; Applied microeconomics; Economics of education

## Research Experience

**Center for Research in Education for Development (CRED)** — Jan. 2026–Present
*Research Assistant; Strategic Program and Operations Manager*

- Research the processes that inform the construction of successful reflection spaces that foster collaborative, intentional, and self-reflective teachers trained in the *Learning to Learn* program, an intervention with striking efficacy as demonstrated by Vesall Nourani's RCT.
- Collaborate with the Harvard Embedded Development Lab (EDL) on action-research projects, grant proposals, and ongoing evaluation of the *Learning to Learn* program.

**Fundación para la Aplicación y Enseñanza de la Ciencia (FUNDAEC)** — Oct. 2025–Apr. 2026
*Christianson Fellow*
Cali, Colombia

- Assisted with the *Growing Hope* program, supported by the Rockefeller Foundation, aimed at addressing food sovereignty in the Norte del Cauca region of Colombia.
- Supported a systematic reflection of the *Preparation for Social Action (PSA)* program across Colombia.

## Prior Research Experience

**Gabriele Bartoli Brain Tumor Laboratory, Columbia University** — 2024–2025
Department of Neurosurgery
Advisors: Drs. Jeffrey Bruce and Peter Canoll

**Kaplitt Laboratory, Cornell University** — 2024–2025
Department of Neurosurgery
Advisor: Dr. Michael Kaplitt

**Beierle Laboratory, University of Alabama at Birmingham** — 2017–2022
Division of Pediatric Surgery, Department of Surgery
Advisor: Dr. Elizabeth Beierle

## Selected Publications in Biomedical Research

*Selected from 20 peer-reviewed publications in biomedical research.* Complete publication list

1. Wadhwani N*, **Markert HR***, Marayati R, et al. "PIM447 inhibits oncogenesis and potentiates cisplatin effects in hepatoblastoma." *Journal of Pediatric Surgery.* 2021. **Equal contribution.*
2. Beierle AM, Quinn CH, **Markert HR**, et al. "Rapid Characterization of Solid Tumors Using Resonant Sensors." *ACS Omega.* 2022.
3. Quinn CH, Julson JR, **Markert HR**, et al. "Oncolytic virotherapy augments self-maintaining natural killer cell line cytotoxicity against neuroblastoma." *Cancer Immunology, Immunotherapy.* 2024.
4. Quinn CH, Julson JR, Erwin MH, **Markert HR**, et al. "Investigation of an oncolytic herpes simplex virus as a potential therapeutic agent for gastroenteropancreatic neuroendocrine neoplasms." *Scientific Reports.* 2025.
5. Bownes LV, Williams AP, Marayati R, Stafman LL, **Markert H**, et al. "EZH2 inhibition decreases neuroblastoma proliferation and *in vivo* tumor growth." *PLoS ONE.* 2021.
6. Stafman LL, Williams AP, Marayati R, Aye JM, **Markert HR**, et al. "Focal Adhesion Kinase Inhibition Contributes to Tumor Cell Survival and Motility in Neuroblastoma Patient-Derived Xenografts." *Scientific Reports.* 2019.

## Selected Biomedical Research Presentations

**Markert HR**, Bownes LV, Julson JR, et al. "PP2A Activation Decreases Viability and Stemness of Neuroendocrine Tumor Cells." Academic Surgical Congress, Houston, TX — Feb. 2023

**Markert HR**, Quinn CH, Beierle AM, et al. "LC Resonant Sensor Differentiation of Intestinal Tissue." Academic Surgical Congress, Orlando, FL — Feb. 2022

**Markert HR**, Quinn CH, Beierle AM, et al. "Resonant Frequencies as a Means of Detecting Metastatic Activity and Characterizing Pediatric Tumor Type." Academic Surgical Congress, Virtual — Feb. 2021

**Markert HR**, Marayati R, Williams AP, et al. "Evaluation of a Novel PIM Inhibitor in Human Hepatoblastoma Cells." Academic Surgical Congress, Orlando, FL — Feb. 2020

## Fellowships & Honors

**Selected Baccalaureate Speaker**, Columbia University — 2025
**Christianson Fellowship**, InterExchange — 2025

## Grant Development & Research Support

**Echidna Giving**, $120,000 — 2026
Contributed to development of successful grant proposal supporting [PROGRAM / RESEARCH PROJECT].

**Two Wings Foundation**, $15,000 — 2026
Contributed to development of successful research support proposal for [PROJECT / RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIP].

## Teaching, Mentoring & Service

**Seminar Facilitator**, Institute for Studies in Global Prosperity 2026–Present
Facilitate undergraduate seminars on social and economic development.

**Co-Founder**, Radiant Youth Foundation 2025–Present
Co-founded a nonprofit supporting educational opportunities for youth from underserved communities.

## Selected Invited Talks

"Bahá'u'lláh's Teachings Find Expression in the Bhagavad Gita," Corinne True Center for Bahá'í History Nov. 2024

## Technical Skills

**Programming & Statistical Software:** Python (numerical modeling, economic simulation, dynamic programming); Stata (regression analysis, statistical inference, data management); MATLAB (data processing and scripting); LaTeX(formal writing, beamer presentations)

**Quantitative Methods:** OLS estimation, hypothesis testing, value-function iteration, dynamic optimization, growth and convergence analysis.

**Geospatial Analysis:** ArcGIS (census-tract mapping, spatial overlays, buffer analysis, geographic data integration).

**Languages:** English (native); Spanish (advanced)